



HERSTORY AFRICA · BRAND BOOK

The women history *forgot* to teach you.

How we look, sound and show up — on the
site, on TikTok, everywhere.

herstoryafrica.com.ng

01 *What we are*

A free archive of African women who shaped history and were left out of the textbooks. 137 women, 24 stories, every region of the continent, no paywall.

*We're not arguing that women matter.
We're showing what they did.*

We are

A history archive

Sourced and fact-checked

For girls *and* boys

Pan-African

Free, forever

We are not

A feminist activism page

Gender debates or rage-bait

A women-only space

Opinions on the news

A "women in tech" listicle

IF SOMEONE CALLS IT A FEMINIST SITE

Reply once, warmly, then move on: *"It's a history archive. If it's true and it was left out, it belongs here. Men are very welcome to learn it too."*

02 Why

School taught us Azikiwe and Awolowo. It didn't teach us that in 1929 ten thousand women shut down British rule in Eastern Nigeria. The women were there. The record just stopped mentioning them.

Young people build their idea of what's possible from the stories they're told. We're putting the missing half back.

MISSION	Make the women history left out as easy to find and share as the men it kept in.
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VISION	A generation of young Africans who can name as many women who shaped the continent as men.
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03 *Who we talk to*

Write for a 17-year-old first. If a Reel works for her, the teacher and the older reader follow the link. The reverse never happens.

FIRST	14–25, on TikTok, Reels, Shorts and WhatsApp status. Wants the "wait, why didn't I know this?" feeling.
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THEN	Students and teachers arriving from Google. Need accurate, citable profiles.
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ALSO	Curious adults on X and the newsletter. Want context and depth.
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04 *What we're chasing*

BE FOUND

Grow past one Google keyword. Today 90% of visits are search, and half land on a single article.

BE WATCHED

A recognisable short-video series people share. Measured in watch-through and shares, not views.

BE TRUSTED

Every claim sourced. Zero avoidable corrections.

BE KEPT

Newsletter subscribers and returning readers. Bounce rate under 70% (it's 84% now).

05 *How we sound*

Like a sharp, well-read older cousin telling you something at a family gathering the teachers never mentioned. Warm, confident, a little wry. Never preachy, never academic, never angry.

Lead with the surprising detail. Let the facts do the arguing.

WORDS WE LOVE

forgot

erased

textbook

she led

she built

she ruled

remember

our history

WORDS WE LEAVE OUT

feminist

empowerment

patriarchy

girlboss

slay

~~women are...~~

~~men are...~~

Each of these turns an archive into a movement. Fine in a quote or a comment, never in our own captions.

06 Logo

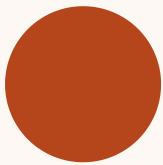
A soft outline of Africa in clay and gold, one centre point, four scattered dots: many stories, one continent. *Her* in terracotta, Story in ink, AFRICA spaced out in gold.



Full logo on the site, end cards and documents. Mark alone for avatars and watermarks. Parchment or dark brown backgrounds only. Don't stretch, recolour, outline or add shadows.

07 Colour

Clay, gold and parchment. Warm, earthy, sunlit. Terracotta leads, gold sparkles, everything else stays soft.



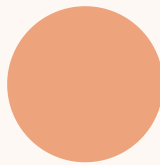
Terracotta

#B5451B



Gold

#C8941A



Clay light

#EDA47D



Blush

#FAE4D6



Cream

#FAF1CC



Parchment

#FDF8F3



Ink

#1C0F07

Forest green #2D8A52 and crimson #E03232 exist for growth and resistance moments. Use them rarely. No pink, purple or pastel gradients: they push us into the lifestyle bucket. Archival photos keep their natural tone or a gentle sepia.

08 Type

Playfair Display for everything you read. Italics are our playful voice: use them for emphasis, questions and the one word that matters. Inter only for tiny labels.

HEADLINE · PLAYFAIR REGULAR

She led 20,000 men against the British.

ACCENT · PLAYFAIR ITALIC

And you were never taught her name.

BODY · PLAYFAIR REGULAR · 18PX

In 1900 the British governor demanded the Golden Stool. The chiefs hesitated. Yaa Asantewaa, queen mother of Ejisu, did not.

LABEL · INTER · SPACED CAPS

GHANA · COLONIAL ERA · RESISTANCE

00 *Pictures*

Real over generated. The whole point is that these women existed. One synthetic face undoes that.

FIRST

Archival photos, portraits, engravings, maps, museum objects. Wikimedia Commons and open-access archives. Credit every source.

THEN

The place and the object: the market she ran, the stool, the coin, the manuscript.

NO PHOTO?

A simple illustrated silhouette in clay and gold, labelled as an artist's impression. Never an AI "reconstruction" of her face.

10 Videos

One woman. One story. 40–60 seconds, vertical. A warm African voice over slow-moving archival images, clean captions, and a closing card with her name and the site.

EVERY VIDEO, IN ORDER

- 1 **Hook** (0–3s) — the most surprising fact. No logo, no "welcome back".
- 2 **Stakes** (3–15s) — what was at risk, who she was up against.
- 3 **Turning point** (15–40s) — what she did. Numbers, places, dates.
- 4 **Consequence** (40–50s) — what changed because of her.
- 5 **Erasure** (50–60s) — "And you were never taught her name." Card, link.

HOOKS THAT SOUND LIKE US

Your history teacher skipped this woman.

In 1929, 10,000 women shut down British rule in Eastern Nigeria.
Nobody put it in your textbook.

number · place · date

She was 16 when she started running the biggest trade network in West Africa.

age contrast

The British called her "the most dangerous woman in Africa". Here's why.

quote the opponent, and source it

CAPTION

Hook · two lines of story · *Full story on herstoryafrica.com.ng* · #HerStoryAfrica
#AfricanHistory #Country #HerName

Three to seven a week. Never the same country twice in a row. Half warriors and rulers, a quarter builders and thinkers, a quarter modern. Every week, at least one story a 17-year-old boy would send his friends.

11 *Never*

Publish a claim we can't source in two clicks

Write a caption that would work on an activism account

Use an AI-generated face for a real woman

Post without a link back to the site

React to trending gender discourse

Forget to credit the photo

A wrong date is a brand failure. A boring video is not.